

French A1 — Week 8 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner French | Week 8

Theme: Home, Neighborhood, and Key Irregular Verbs

What You Will Learn This Week

Week 8 has two focuses. Session 15 takes you inside a French home — you'll learn the rooms, the furniture, and how to describe where things are. Session 16 moves outside to your neighborhood and introduces five high-frequency irregular verbs that you need for almost every conversation.

By the end of this week, you should be able to describe your home and neighborhood in 5–6 spoken sentences — combining vocabulary, prepositions, and the new verbs in real output.

What You Will Be Able to Say by the End of Week 8

Describing your home:

J'habite dans un appartement au deuxième étage. Il y a trois pièces: un salon, une chambre et une cuisine. Il n'y a pas de jardin mais il y a un petit balcon. Le canapé est devant la télévision. L'armoire est à côté du lit.

Describing your neighborhood:

Mon quartier est calme et pratique. Il y a une boulangerie au coin de la rue et un parc en face de chez moi. Je prends le métro pour aller au travail — la station est à cinq minutes à pied. Je connais bien mon quartier. Je sais où est tout.

Il y a — The Essential Phrase

Il y a means "there is" or "there are." It is always the same — it does not change for singular or plural:

- Il y a une chambre.* — There is one bedroom.
- Il y a trois chambres.* — There are three bedrooms.
- Il n'y a pas de garage.* — There isn't a garage.

Negation rule: *Il n'y a pas de* — same rule as always. After *pas*, the article disappears: *pas de* (never *pas d'un, pas du, pas des*).

Prepositions of Place

To describe where things are in your home:

French	English
sur	on
sous	under
devant	in front of

derrière	behind
entre	between
à côté de	next to
en face de	opposite / facing

De + le = du (mandatory contraction):

- à côté **du** lit (de + le lit)
- en face **du** salon (de + le salon)
- au bout **du** couloir (de + le couloir)

When *de* is followed by *le*, they always contract to *du*. You've already seen this contraction with partitive articles (*du café*) — it's the same *du*.

The Five Irregular Verbs This Week

Faire (to do / to make)

je	tu	il/elle	nous	vous	ils/elles
fais	fais	fait	faisons	faites	font

Vous faites and *ils font* are the irregular forms to memorize.

Venir (to come)

je	tu	il/elle	nous	vous	ils/elles
viens	viens	vient	venons	venez	viennent

Je viens de Paris. — I'm from Paris. / I come from Paris.

Prendre (to take)

je	tu	il/elle	nous	vous	ils/elles
prends	prends	prend	prenons	prenez	prennent

Je prends le métro. — I take the metro.

Savoir (to know a fact or skill)

je	tu	il/elle	nous	vous	ils/elles
sais	sais	sait	savons	savez	savent

Je sais où est la gare. — I know where the station is. *Je ne sais pas.* — I don't know.

Connaître (to know a person or place)

je	tu	il/elle	nous	vous	ils/elles
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connais	connais	connaît	connaissons	connaissez	connaissent
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Je connais Paris. — I know Paris (I'm familiar with it). *Tu connais Marie?* — Do you know Marie?

Savoir vs. Connaître — One Minute Explanation

Use <i>savoir</i> for...	Use <i>connaître</i> for...
facts (<i>Je sais qu'il habite ici</i>)	people (<i>Je connais Pierre</i>)
skills (<i>Elle sait nager</i>)	places (<i>Tu connais Lyon?</i>)
information (<i>Vous savez l'heure?</i>)	familiarity (<i>Je connais bien ce café</i>)

Quick test: if you're saying you know a person or are familiar with a place → *connaître*. Everything else (facts, skills, information) → *savoir*.

What to Practice Between Sessions

After Session 15 — before Session 16:

1. **Say *il y a* for your home.** *Il y a [X] pièces. Il y a... Il n'y a pas de...* — 4–5 sentences, no notes on the third try.
2. **Practice one preposition.** Pick one room and place 3 items in it using prepositions: *Le lit est devant la fenêtre. L'armoire est à côté du lit.*
3. **Learn 5 room names and 5 furniture items.** Say each with its gender.

After Session 16 — before Session 17:

1. **Write your home and neighborhood description.** 5–7 sentences. Use *il y a*, *être* + preposition, *faire*, *venir*, and one of *savoir/connaître*.
2. **Say it without notes.** Third try.
3. **Learn *je ne sais pas*.** This phrase is so common in French conversation that it should be completely automatic.

A Note on Mistakes This Week

The most common error this week is **mixing up *il y a* and *être* for location**. Both talk about things in space, but differently:

- *Il y a un canapé dans le salon.* — There is a sofa in the living room. (announcing its existence)
- *Le canapé est devant la télévision.* — The sofa is in front of the TV. (placing a known sofa)

When you introduce something for the first time: *il y a*. When you then describe where it is: *être* + preposition. You will use both in the same home description — that is exactly right.

Crescere — French A1 Week 8 / Questions? Contact your instructor.